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Helping Ghanaian businesses get seen and get paid

Guide 2: Network vs. Net Worth

Why working with other businesses around you can help you grow faster than working alone.

Many shop owners open their shop in the morning, sit behind the counter, and wait for people to walk past. This is called the Old Way. The problem is, you only reach the people who happen to walk on your street that day.

The Old Way: Working Alone

You open your shop and hope someone walks by and looks inside. Your reach is limited to the small stretch of pavement outside your own door.

The New Way: Working as a Team

Instead of waiting alone, you team up with other shop owners nearby who serve the same kind of customers but sell different things. When you combine your customers, everyone gets more business. Partner with BYINFORGH

Example: Three Shops, One Team

Example (for illustration, not a real case)

A barber, a shoe seller, and a kenkey seller all work on the same street in a town like Koforidua. Every guy who gets a haircut also cares about his shoes. The barber does not sell shoes, but he meets many style conscious men every day. If the barber keeps a small card or a QR code for the shoe shop at his station, the shoe seller now reaches all of the barber's customers too without paying for adverts.

Example: Using Food to Pull a Crowd

Example (for illustration, not a real case)

The kenkey seller offers a small "Friday Kenkey deal." Food is something that pulls a crowd. The point is not to make a big profit from the kenkey it is to bring more people walking past the shoe shop and the barber shop at the same time on Fridays.



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The Big Idea

You do not grow a business only by competing with the shop next to you. You grow by sharing customers with shops that sell different things to the same kind of people. When local businesses work together like this, the customer's money stays moving within that small circle of partners, and everyone benefits.

Try This Today

- Make a short list of 3 nearby businesses that serve the same kind of customer as you, but do not sell the same product.
- Pick one of them and suggest a simple swap. For example, you display their flyer, and they display yours.
- Agree on one simple offer you can promote together, such as a discount for customers who use both businesses.

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